



I LURVE YOU, YOU KNOW? I LOAVE YOU. I LUFF YOU. TWO 'F'S

ANNIE HALL / 1977

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Romantic comedy

DIRECTOR

Woody Allen

WRITERS

**Woody Allen,
Marshall Brickman**

STARS

Woody Allen, Diane Keaton, Tony Roberts

BEFORE

1933 The Marx brothers, a huge influence on Allen, make *Duck Soup* (p.48). He later uses a clip from it in his movie *Hannah and Her Sisters* (1986).

1973 Ingmar Bergman's *Scenes from a Marriage* shows a married couple's ups and downs in a hyper-realistic way.

AFTER

1993 Allen and Keaton reunite on screen for the last time to date in the director's *Manhattan Murder Mystery*.

Woody Allen's 1977 movie *Annie Hall* is a New York romantic comedy with its two elements in perfect balance. Allen himself plays comedian Alvy Singer, and Diane Keaton, Allen's girlfriend at the time, plays Annie Hall. The movie is imbued with Allen's trademark neurotic humor, and may have been a comic reflection of the ups and downs of his real-life relationship with Keaton.

It is also very much a document of its time and place, focusing as it does on the preoccupations of the late 1970s Manhattan intelligentsia, with their long-winded, competitive opining on the meaning of art, film, and literature. Alvy lampoons their pretentiousness while at the same time reveling in it.



Allen's movie stole the Best Picture Oscar from *Star Wars*, a rare example of a small, intellectual movie beating a major blockbuster to the coveted prize.

As a New Yorker, Alvy is dismissive of Los Angeles, which he sees as a

cultural wasteland. Upon receiving an invitation to present an award on TV there, he replies: "In Beverly Hills, they don't throw their garbage away. They turn it into television shows." And when Annie expresses a desire to go to LA, Alvy sees it as a defect in her personality. At the same time, however, he recognizes that he is trapped by the persona that New York has given him.

“A relationship, I think, is **like a shark**. You know? It has to constantly **move forward** or **it dies**. And I think what we got on our hands is **a dead shark**.”

Alvy Singer / Annie Hall